

2c. Content of Psychological themes through core studies (Component 02)

Psychological themes through core studies (Component 02) aims to develop the critical thinking and independent learning skills essential to the scientific study of psychology through a focus on some of the key themes investigated within the subject. For each key theme, learners are presented with both a classic and a contemporary study. The classic studies are 'landmark' pieces of research that have helped to shape the course of the subject and which all learners of psychology should become familiar with.

The contemporary studies are more 'up-to-date' pieces of research that engage in some way with the issues being explored in the classic studies they are paired with. The core studies chosen reflect the contribution of psychology to an understanding of individual, social and cultural diversity.

It also develops learners' ability to make evaluative points about the studies and their ability to see the studies in the wider perspective of psychological areas/perspectives, issues and debates.